

Maria Silva

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am applying for the paralegal role advertised through Adecco, based in Farringdon. My background in dispute resolution, case management and client-facing legal work means I can contribute from day one rather than requiring a long settling-in period, which matters in a six-month contract.

At Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner, where I spent a year on placement split between international arbitration and real estate disputes, I managed document review, maintained structured electronic case files across several concurrent matters, and tracked procedural deadlines under genuine time pressure. Toward the end of the arbitration seat, I became the only junior supporting the team shortly before a significant submission deadline. That required me to coordinate outstanding documents, liaise with external translators and keep the file organised enough that the supervising lawyers could work efficiently. A partner and associate told me afterwards that my performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor. That kind of environment, where the work is high-stakes and the standard expected is high, is where I have found I work best.

Since graduating I have been advising clients at Citizens Advice East Berkshire on welfare, housing, employment and debt matters. I take detailed factual statements, identify evidential gaps, draft correspondence and submissions, and manage cases from first interview through to completion. The work has sharpened my ability to handle competing deadlines across a varied caseload while keeping records accurate and clients properly informed. It has also given me experience communicating complex legal requirements clearly to people who are often in difficult circumstances, which has made my written and spoken communication more precise.

What draws me to this role is the chance to work on high-profile matters within a structured legal team for a defined period where I can make a concrete contribution. My dispute resolution background, experience with document-heavy matters, and the organisational habits I have built across different legal settings are directly applicable to the kind of paralegal support this role appears to require. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss the position further.

Yours sincerely,
Maria Silva